

This guide is going to follow the steps I took to set up a multiplayer split screen experience. There's probably other ways to do this in Unity but I made use of Player Input and two virtual cameras.

First thing I did was create my player prefab with charactercontroller/rigidbody and player input. This may seem unimportant but it allows for you to edit your players and give them both major updates together. Then put both in your scene. From there, assign different playerinput bindings using Unity's player input system.

To use Unity's player input system first you must install it in the package manager. Then you have to double click the player input system in the content browser and begin creating. For instance when I wanted to create movement for player 1, who I have using keyboard and mouse, I put Action (move) set to value and any. Then a 2D vector and inside WASD movement. For player 2 I create a new action map and make move a value control type any, add a binding composite with a 2D vector then 4 bindings for the cardinal directions on the joystick.

Now with two movement maps to place onto each player input in the inspector, we need to set up the cameras. Add two camera objects as children to your player objects in a scene. Then, under Camera → output in inspector, change your viewport recs as wanted! In my build, they take up half the screen sliced vertically. So mine are 0.5 W.

Setting up UI is just as easy. For me, I have real time UI editing, so the implementation is a little more complex. My hierarchy is UI (canvas) ->

TMPGUIs. In the UI (canvas) inspector under Canvas, change the render mode to “screen space - camera.” This will lock the UI behind the camera in the correct place.

Following these quick and easy steps will get you to split screen co-op in no time. Just make sure your input mapping is as accurate as possible to what you want, the less vague the better.